CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

JEWELRY MAKER IN THE AI ERA

Mass-produced sparkle is cheap and instant. A ring made by a human hand, for one human — that's the opposite of a commodity.

★ **TL;DR — The deal: bench-made jewelry sold direct or on commission for around ~$45K median, learnable in 1–6 months of core skills. The catch: the median hides two worlds — hobby income and a real bench business.** ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

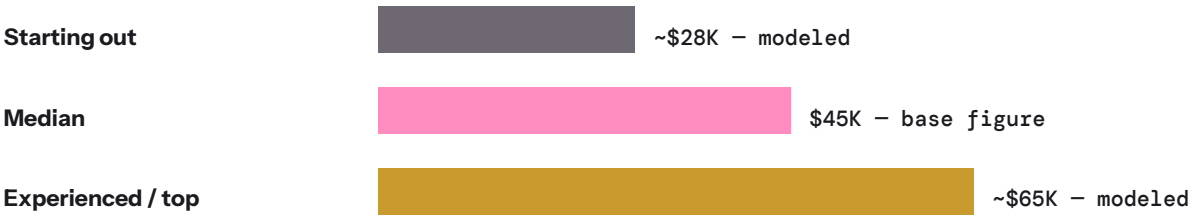
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$45K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK LOW

- Hands are the moat: soldering, stone-setting and repair can't be downloaded.
- Design software drafts pieces, but metal, fire and polish stay physical.
- Repairs and custom work pay steadier than hoping a collection goes viral.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Jewelry Maker is a ~$45K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A JEWELRY MAKER ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Design and make pieces: sawing, soldering, forming, polishing
- ✓ Set stones and finish pieces to a standard strangers pay for

✓ Repair, resize and restore customers' jewelry

✓ Price, photograph and sell your work online and in person

Think: a tiny factory, a chemistry lab and an art studio — one bench, one person.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Design renderings, pricing calculators and product photos get machine help. Trend research and listings write themselves now.	Fire, metal and stones behave in person, not in simulations. The feel of a perfect polish and a setting that holds for decades is bench judgment.

⚠ **Tools and materials cost real money before the first sale, and precious metal prices don't care about your margins.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ Quiet bench work, music on, world off ✓ Pieces you make outlive trends — and you ✓ Sell from home, markets, or your own small studio	✗ Eyes, back and fingers take the strain ✗ Materials inventory eats cash quietly ✗ Slow months exist; custom clients are weather

Good fit? Precise hands, patient temperament, and you light up at tiny details others can't see.
Bad fit? You want fast money or get bored repeating a finish until it's flawless.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — BENCH WORK FOR A JEWELER	DOOR B — YOUR OWN LINE
Work a bench in an existing jewelry shop: repairs and production on their metal, their customers, their insurance. The fastest skills education there is.	Design and sell your own pieces online and at markets from the start. Full margin, full risk — you are maker, photographer and shop.

Smart move: Offer resizing and repair locally from week one. Repair clients trust you with small jobs first — then commission the big ones.
Where you land after: A custom-and-repair bench with a waitlist, your own storefront, or a signature line sold wholesale.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
LEARN THE	SET UP	MAKE A	SELL AND	ADD STONE-SETTI	SYSTEMATIZE THE

STEP 1 — Learn the core bench skills

COURSE · 1-6 MONTHS

- Take a hands-on metalsmithing course: sawing, soldering, forming, polishing
- No license is required — skill is proven at the bench, not on paper

STEP 2 — Set up a safe bench

TOOLS · BUDGET FIRST

- Buy the essential torch, tools and ventilation before the pretty extras
- Start in copper and silver — gold is tuition you don't need to pay yet

STEP 3 — Make a first collection

10-15 PIECES

- Design a tight range you'd wear yourself, priced with materials and hours counted
- Photograph everything in daylight — your phone is the shop window

STEP 4 — Sell and repair

FIRST INCOME

- List online, take a market table, and advertise local repair and resizing
- Every customer gets a card — repairs become commissions

STEP 5 — Add stone-setting

SKILL UPGRADE · WEEKS

- Learn basic setting and finishing to professional standard
- Higher-value work lives where stones meet metal

STEP 6 — Systematize the business

YEAR ONE

- Track materials, hours and margins per piece — price from data
- Build repeat channels: one shop account or a loyal market slot

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- □ Today: price a starter bench setup honestly — tools, torch, safety, first metals.
- □ Days 1–30: course started or booked; first practice pieces in copper and silver finished.
- □ Days 31–60: first small collection made and photographed; repair offer posted locally.
- □ Days 61–90: first sales and repair jobs completed; margins reviewed piece by piece.

□ Day 90: real people have paid for your work, and you know which pieces earn.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ MADE BY HAND. WORN FOR LIFE. ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.